

IN THE UNITED STATES DISTRICT COURT
NORTHERN DISTRICT OF FLORIDA
PENSACOLA DIVISION

DEBRA NELSON

Plaintiff,

V.

Amentum Government Services Parent Holdings LLC, CLARENCE XANDER, JANICE HUGHES, HEATHER GUNN, DAKOTA THOMAS, ELIAS VELASQUEZ And USEF ABDUL-JAMI.

Defendants.

C.A. No.: 3:25-cv-01447-MCR-ZCB

SEVENTH AMENDED COMPLAINT AND DEMAND FOR JURY TRIAL

I. INTRODUCTION

1. Plaintiff files this Seventh Amended Complaint to fully incorporate and consolidate exhausted claims regarding her retaliatory termination, along with newly received administrative findings and regulatory filings that demonstrate a systemic pattern of discrimination and retaliation.
2. Plaintiff was employed by Defendant Amentum as a **Non-Destructive-Inspection (NDI) Technician** at the NAS Whiting Field facility in Milton, Florida, from November 18, 2024, until her unlawful and retaliatory termination on October 29, 2025.
3. Throughout her tenure, Plaintiff repeatedly acted as a whistleblower, reporting critical safety, quality, and regulatory compliance violations.
4. In response to her protected activity, Defendants orchestrated a hostile work environment, fabricated disciplinary records to create a pretextual "paper trail," and ultimately terminated her employment less than 24 hours after she provided sworn testimony in a federal civil rights lawsuit.

5. This action seeks redress for violations of **Title VII of the Civil Rights Act of 1964**, the **Florida Whistleblower Act**, **42 U.S.C. § 1985(3)**, and various Florida common law torts.

II. JURISDICTION AND VENUE

6. This Court has **subject-matter jurisdiction** under 28 U.S.C. § 1331 (federal question) and 1367 (supplemental jurisdiction over state law claims).
7. The claims arise under Title VII of the Civil Rights Act of 1964, 42 U.S.C. §§ 2000e-2 and 2000e-3; the Florida Whistleblower Act, Fla. Stat. § 448.102(3); and 42 U.S.C. § 1985(3).
8. **Venue is proper** in the Northern District of Florida because the events occurred at NAS Whiting Field in Milton, FL, and the Defendants conduct business within this Division.

III. THE PARTIES

9. **Plaintiff Debra Nelson** is a resident of North Charleston, South Carolina.
10. **Defendant Amentum Government Services Parent Holdings LLC** is a federal defense contractor and an “employer” within the meaning of Title VII.
11. **Defendant Clarence Xander** was the Site Manager at NAS Whiting Field and acted in a supervisory capacity.
12. **Defendant Janice Hughes** was an HR Generalist.
13. **Defendant Heather Gunn** was the Business Manager.
14. **Defendant Dakota Thomas** was the first shift Maintenance Supervisor.
15. **Defendant Elias Velasquez** was the second shift Maintenance Supervisor.
16. **Defendant Yusef Abdul-Jami** was an NDI Technician and a coworker of the Plaintiff who participated in the discriminatory and retaliatory scheme.

IV. EXHAUSTION OF ADMINISTRATIVE REMEDIES

17. Plaintiff has meticulously satisfied all statutory conditions precedent to filing this action.
18. **EEOC Charges:**
 1. Plaintiff filed an initial **Charge of Discrimination (No. 510-2025-08373)** on August 14, 2025, for gender discrimination and harassment.

2. On **March 3, 2026**, Plaintiff filed a second **Charge of Discrimination (No. 510-2026-05627)** specifically addressing her **retaliatory termination**.
3. On **March 6, 2026**, the EEOC issued a **Notice of Right to Sue** for Charge No. 510-2026-05627, terminating its processing and authorizing this litigation.
19. **FAA Whistleblower Protection:** On February 24, 2026, the FAA Whistleblower Protection Program received Plaintiff's report regarding safety violations, assigned **Reference No. AAE-EWB-20260224-924**.
20. **NLRB Proceedings:** On February 19, 2026, the NLRB docketed **Case No. 15-CA-381573** regarding Amentum's unfair labor practices, specifically retaliation and unlawful termination.
21. **OFCCP Complaint:** On February 9, 2026, Plaintiff filed a formal complaint with the **Office of Federal Contract Compliance Programs** regarding gender-based unequal treatment and retaliation by a federal contractor.

V. FACTUAL ALLEGATIONS

A. The May 28, 2025 Incident and Gender-Coded Hostility

22. On May 28, 2025, at approximately 2:25 p.m., five minutes before the end of Plaintiff's scheduled shift, Plaintiff was called into a meeting in the equipment room by Defendant **Elias Velasquez**, the Second Shift Maintenance Supervisor.
23. Present in the meeting were Velasquez, First Shift Maintenance Supervisor **Dakota Thomas**, Union Representative **Jimmy Murphy**, NDI Technician **Yusef Abdul-Jami**, and Plaintiff.
24. Velasquez began questioning Plaintiff regarding the contents of "Locker 2." Plaintiff responded that Abdul-Jami was responsible for the locker and pointed to him as he was standing nearby.
25. Velasquez reacted angrily and stated to Plaintiff: *"You don't have to have an attitude and you don't need this fucking shit in here."*
26. Plaintiff immediately objected and told Velasquez that he had no right to curse at her. The other men present said nothing and did not intervene.
27. Velasquez then instructed Plaintiff that NDI spare probes and equipment would be stored in the Tool Room rather than in the NDI equipment area.

28. Plaintiff explained that NDI procedures required spare parts to remain with NDI equipment and advised Velasquez that he should consult the **NDI Level III** before altering NDI process control procedures.
29. Velasquez refused to consult the Level III and insisted that the probes and cables would be placed in the Tool Room. Dakota Thomas agreed with Velasquez.
30. Immediately after the meeting, Plaintiff reported Velasquez's conduct to Human Resources.

B. May 29, 2025 Management Meeting and Retaliatory Characterization

31. On May 29, 2025, Plaintiff attended a meeting with **Clarence Xander**, Site Manager; **Janice Hughes**, HR Generalist; **Heather Gunn**, Business Manager; **Dakota Thomas**, Maintenance Supervisor; **James Carnley**, Chief Union Steward; and Plaintiff.
32. Plaintiff reported Velasquez's profanity and explained that Abdul-Jami had not maintained **NDI process control compliance**, which could expose the company to regulatory penalties if aircraft inspections were conducted without proper documentation.
33. Instead of addressing the safety concern, Defendant **Clarence Xander** told Plaintiff she had an "attitude" and described her communications with Abdul-Jami as "aggressive."
34. When Plaintiff asked why Velasquez was not disciplined for cursing at her, Xander responded that "*you cursed too.*"
35. Plaintiff denied making any such statement and repeatedly asked what she was accused of saying. Xander refused to provide details and repeatedly stated "*it doesn't matter.*"
36. No corrective action was taken against Velasquez or Abdul-Jami.

C. Medical Leave and Unauthorized Alteration of Time Records

37. Due to the hostile work environment and stress, Plaintiff began a leave of absence on **May 30, 2025**.
38. On the same day Plaintiff attempted to log into the Costpoint payroll system to certify her time but discovered she had been locked out of the system.
39. On **June 2, 2025**, Plaintiff contacted Payroll Specialist **Tionne Thomas** to reset her password.
40. After regaining access, Plaintiff discovered that her time records had been modified.

- 41. Payroll informed Plaintiff that **Heather Gunn** had accessed and signed Plaintiff's timesheet on May 30, 2025.
- 42. Plaintiff did not authorize Gunn to access or alter her time records.
- 43. Plaintiff requested that Payroll reopen the timesheet so she could correct the entries.
- 44. Plaintiff reasonably believed the modification of her time records was an attempt to create an appearance that she had improperly recorded work hours.

D. Return From Leave and Continuing Retaliation

- 45. On **July 2, 2025**, Plaintiff returned from leave and attended a meeting with **Clarence Xander, Heather Gunn, Dakota Thomas, James Carnley**, and Plaintiff.
- 46. Plaintiff had previously stated she would return once discrepancies in the NDI program were corrected.
- 47. Upon returning, Plaintiff discovered that a broken probe and other non-compliant equipment remained in the NDI kit.
- 48. Plaintiff again asked Xander about the allegation that she had cursed at a supervisor. Xander again refused to explain the accusation and stated that "*it doesn't matter.*"
- 49. Plaintiff informed Xander that falsely accusing her of misconduct constituted defamation.
- 50. Xander ended the meeting without addressing Plaintiff's concerns.

E. Safety Violations and Inspection Irregularities

- 51. On **July 24, 2025**, Plaintiff conducted a **6300-hour eddy current inspection** on aircraft **166037** in the Phase Hangar.
- 52. On **July 25, 2025**, Plaintiff learned from Phase Lead **Tom Beauman** that the aircraft had not been properly defueled and required additional panel removal before the inspection could be properly performed.
- 53. Beauman informed Plaintiff that a similar incident had previously occurred involving NDI Technician **Yusef Abdul-Jami**.
- 54. Plaintiff reported the status of the aircraft inspection to Shop Lead **Phillip Sorrow**.
- 55. On **July 29, 2025**, Plaintiff attended a meeting with **Dakota Thomas, Heather Gunn, Janice Hughes, Elias Velasquez, James Carnley**, and Plaintiff regarding the inspection.

56. Plaintiff explained the circumstances and noted that Abdul-Jami had previously made a similar error but had not been subjected to the same scrutiny.

F. Equipment Failure and Safety Reporting

57. On **July 30, 2025**, Plaintiff was assigned an eddy current inspection but discovered that the inspection cable was defective.

58. Plaintiff attempted to obtain a replacement cable but none were available.

59. Plaintiff checked the Tool Room, which management had previously designated for spare parts, but Tool Room staff informed Plaintiff that no NDI equipment was stored there.

60. As a result, Plaintiff could not perform the required eddy current inspection.

61. Later that day Plaintiff conducted a **fluorescent penetrant inspection** on propellers for aircraft **166182** and identified multiple defects.

62. Plaintiff documented the defects in the OOMA system and reported them to **Elias Velasquez**.

63. Velasquez initially believed the propellers would be painted, but Plaintiff informed him that the defects required blending before any painting could occur.

64. Velasquez stated the propellers would be reinspected during day shift.

65. Plaintiff later learned that no maintenance records existed showing the propellers were reinspected or repaired.

G. False Turnover Log Entry and Hostile Work Environment

66. On **August 4, 2025**, Plaintiff discovered that **Yusef Abdul-Jami** had entered a note in the turnover log claiming that the cable Plaintiff reported as defective was functioning properly before and after Plaintiff used it.

67. Plaintiff maintains the cable was defective and had verified the defect using multiple probes.

68. Plaintiff reported the issue to Velasquez and expressed concern that Abdul-Jami had replaced the cable to discredit her report.

69. Velasquez immediately defended Abdul-Jami and told Plaintiff that she had an "attitude," stating that Plaintiff would "look stupid" if she filed a report.

70. Plaintiff reasonably believed this treatment reflected gender-based bias and a hostile work environment.

H. Removal of NDI Workspace

71. During the week of **August 4–8, 2025**, management informed Plaintiff that the NDI department could no longer use the Safety Office as its designated workspace.

72. As a result, the NDI department no longer had a dedicated shop or office location.

73. Plaintiff was required to perform NDI work in rotating locations within the facility.

74. Plaintiff had never previously worked in an NDI program without a dedicated workspace.

I. Fabricated Accusation and Written Reprimand

75. On **August 5, 2025**, corporate management informed Plaintiff that she had been accused of saying *“Who the fuck do you think you are.”*

76. Plaintiff categorically denies making this statement.

77. Management refused to identify the individual who made the accusation.

78. Plaintiff reasonably believes the accusation was fabricated in retaliation for her complaints.

79. On **August 6, 2025**, **Dakota Thomas, Janice Hughes, and Heather Gunn** issued Plaintiff a written reprimand for **“unauthorized absence.”**

80. The reprimand concerned Plaintiff’s absence on **July 31 and August 1, 2025** for a scheduled court date.

81. Plaintiff had previously informed **Elias Velasquez** and Payroll Specialist **Tionne Thomas** that she did not have sufficient leave time and would need to use personal time and unauthorized leave, which had been allowed in the past.

82. Plaintiff was never informed that the leave request had been denied.

J. Union Grievance Process

83. On **August 6, 2025**, Plaintiff spoke with **Jamie Littlefield**, ADBR, regarding grievances involving gender discrimination, retaliation, hostile work environment, and disability leave.

84. Plaintiff was informed that management personnel would be required to undergo training as a result of her complaints.
85. Plaintiff was also informed that a **Step 3 grievance meeting** would be scheduled.
86. On **August 18, 2025**, Plaintiff emailed Littlefield requesting scheduling of the Step 3 grievance meeting. (**Exhibit A**).
87. On **October 16, 2025**, Plaintiff again contacted Littlefield offering to meet at a neutral location. (**Exhibits B–C**).
88. Littlefield refused to schedule the meeting unless Plaintiff returned to the workplace.

K. Management Demand to Return to Work

89. On **September 18, 2025**, HR Representative **Ja'nicé Hughes** emailed Plaintiff demanding that she return to work.
90. Plaintiff responded that management had done "**nothing about the hostile work environment.**" (**Exhibit D**).

L. Termination

91. On **October 29, 2025**, Plaintiff received a termination notice from **Amentum Government Services Parent Holdings LLC**. (**Exhibit E**).
92. The termination relied upon the same disputed accusations and disciplinary actions described above.
93. Plaintiff alleges the termination was the culmination of the retaliatory conduct described throughout this complaint.

COUNT I – GENDER DISCRIMINATION (TITLE VII)

(Against Defendant Amentum)

94. Plaintiff is a female employee, a member of a protected class.
95. Defendant Amentum treated Plaintiff less favorably than similarly situated male employees, specifically NDI Technician **Yusef Abdul-Jami**.
96. **Disparate Treatment in Job Assignments:** Plaintiff was coerced into taking on a heavier workload and time-consuming tasks while Abdul-Jami received lighter assignments and was not held accountable for failing to maintain "process control compliance.".

97. **Disparate Treatment in Discipline:** Plaintiff was subjected to verbal abuse by Velasquez and accused of having an "attitude" and displaying "aggressive" behavior, while Abdul-Jami and other male coworkers were not subjected to such scrutiny or character attacks despite documented safety and performance issues.
98. **Gender-Based Motive:** The discriminatory intent is evidenced by Site Manager Xander's use of **gender-coded language** ("aggressive," "attitude") to describe the Plaintiff's technical reports of safety violations. These terms were not applied to male employees.
99. As a direct result of this discrimination, Plaintiff has suffered a loss of wages, loss of promotion opportunities, and severe emotional distress.

COUNT II – RETALIATION (TITLE VII)

(Against Defendant Amentum)

100. Plaintiff engaged in **statutorily protected activity** by: a. Reporting safety and compliance violations (May 2025). b. Filing an internal Ethics complaint (August 5, 2025). c. Filing an EEOC Charge of Discrimination (August 14, 2025). d. Providing **sworn deposition testimony** in a federal civil rights lawsuit (October 28, 2025).
101. **Materially Adverse Employment Actions:** Amentum took a series of adverse actions, including fabricating disciplinary warnings for "no-call-no-show" and "unauthorized leave," and the **ultimate adverse action of termination** on October 29, 2025.
102. **Causal Connection:** A clear causal link exists through **extreme temporal proximity**. Plaintiff was terminated less than 24 hours after providing testimony regarding Amentum's misconduct.
103. The reasons provided for the termination were purely **pretextual**, as the "unauthorized leave" had been previously approved by Payroll and the "unprofessional conduct" was based on a fabricated accusation ("Who the fuck do you think you are") that was concealed from the Plaintiff until it could be used to justify her firing.

COUNT III – HOSTILE WORK ENVIRONMENT (TITLE VII)

(Against Defendant Amentum)

104. Plaintiff was subjected to unwelcome harassment based on her sex that was **severe and pervasive** enough to alter the terms and conditions of her employment.
105. The hostile environment included: a. **Verbal abuse:** Supervisor Velasquez cursing at Plaintiff in front of male peers and shouting "Plaintiff don't have to have an attitude.". b. **Gendered Gaslighting:** Site Manager Xander falsely accusing Plaintiff of cursing and then

stating "it doesn't matter" when asked for proof, effectively silencing her. c. **Workspace Isolation:** Stripping the NDI department of a dedicated office and forcing Plaintiff to work in rotating locations. d. **Refusal to Remedially Act:** Management repeatedly dismissed Plaintiff's reports of safety violations and Abdul-Jami's non-compliance, choosing instead to label the Plaintiff as "aggressive."

106. This conduct resulted in Plaintiff being forced to take **two different medical leaves of absence** for anxiety, sleeplessness, and emotional trauma. Amentum knew of the harassment and failed to take prompt remedial action.

COUNT IV – DEFAMATION (FLORIDA COMMON LAW)

(Against Defendants Velasquez, Xander, Thomas, and Hughes)

107. **False Statements:** a. **Hughes and Thomas** published a written memorandum to Amentum management stating Plaintiff took "**unauthorized leave**" when they knew the leave was authorized. b. **Velasquez** falsely accused Plaintiff of cursing during the May 28 meeting. c. **Xander** falsely stated to Plaintiff and management that "**Plaintiff cursed too**" to justify the lack of discipline for Velasquez.

108. **Publication to Third Parties:** These false statements were communicated to Amentum Corporate management and coworkers, and were **permanently placed in Plaintiff's personnel file**.

109. These communications are **not privileged** because they were made with **actual malice** and a reckless disregard for the truth for the express purpose of creating a pretext for Plaintiff's retaliatory termination.

110. These statements caused Plaintiff reputational harm, loss of employment, and severe emotional distress.

COUNT V – INTENTIONAL INFLICTION OF EMOTIONAL DISTRESS

(Against Defendants Amentum, Velasquez, Hughes, and Thomas)

111. Defendants engaged in **extreme and outrageous conduct** that goes beyond all possible bounds of decency in a civilized society.

112. Specifically, Defendants **coordinated a fabrication** of disciplinary records to frame a Black female employee for termination immediately following her exercise of her legal right to testify in a federal civil rights case.

113. The conduct included: a. Fabricating a racially and gender-biased accusation ("Who the fuck do you think you are") to set her up for termination. b. Shouting and cursing at

Plaintiff in a small equipment room (Velasquez). c. Terminating her employment **less than 24 hours** after a federal deposition.

114. This conduct was intended to cause, and did cause, **severe emotional distress**, including humiliation, anxiety, and ongoing emotional trauma requiring medical leave.

COUNT VI – CIVIL CONSPIRACY (42 U.S.C. § 1985(3))

(Against Individual Defendants Xander, Hughes, Gunn, Thomas, Velasquez, and Abdul-Jami)

115. The individual Defendants **knowingly acted in concert** and reached an agreement to deprive Plaintiff of the equal protection of the laws on the basis of her sex.
116. **Overt Acts in Furtherance of the Conspiracy:** a. Velasquez and Thomas **concealed FAA-related safety violations** to protect Abdul-Jami. b. Xander, Hughes, and Gunn **coordinated to discredit Plaintiff** by labeling her "aggressive" to divert attention from her safety reporting. c. The Defendants **manipulated disciplinary procedures** and fabricated "unauthorized leave" to justify her termination.
117. This conspiracy was specifically aimed at interfering with Plaintiff's right to provide **unimpeded federal testimony**, as evidenced by the immediate termination following her deposition.
118. Defendants acted **outside the normal scope of employment** by engaging in the intentional fabrication of records and the concealment of federal safety violations.

COUNT VII – NEGLIGENT SUPERVISION (FLORIDA COMMON LAW)

(Against Defendant Amentum)

119. Defendant Amentum had a legal duty to supervise its managers and ensure they did not engage in tortious or unsafe conduct.
120. Amentum **breached this duty** by: a. Failing to supervise and correct documented **FAA-related safety violations** after notice. b. Permitting **false and unverified accusations** to remain in Plaintiff's file. c. Failing to discipline Velasquez after he was reported for verbal abuse.
121. Amentum knew or should have known its supervisors were engaging in retaliatory and procedurally improper conduct, as Plaintiff had filed numerous internal reports and an EEOC charge.
122. This breach was the proximate cause of Plaintiff's emotional distress and economic losses.

COUNT VIII – FLORIDA WHISTLEBLOWER ACT (FLA. STAT. § 448.102)

(Against Defendant Amentum)

123. Plaintiff objected to and refused to participate in activities that violated actual laws, rules, or regulations, specifically: a. **FAA safety regulations** regarding the inspection of aircraft (e.g., Aircraft 166037) without proper preparation or process control. b. Violations of **NDI Level III requirements** by failing to replace broken probes and cables essential for safe aircraft inspection. c. The failure to reinspect or repair propeller defects on **Aircraft 166182**.
124. In response to these objections, Amentum took **retaliatory personnel actions**, including: a. Instructing Plaintiff not to communicate with coworkers about safety (Silencing). b. Subjecting her to **gender-coded criticism** to minimize her technical findings. c. **Fabricating "unauthorized leave"** records to terminate her immediately after her deposition.
125. These actions constitute a direct violation of Fla. Stat. § 448.102(3).

VII. DAMAGES

126. As a direct result of Defendants' unlawful conduct, Plaintiff has suffered: a. **Back Pay and Front Pay:** Loss of wages and benefits from October 29, 2025, through the date of judgment. b. **Compensatory Damages:** For emotional distress, mental anguish, loss of enjoyment of life, and reputational injury. c. **Punitive Damages:** Against Defendants Amentum and the individual Defendants for conduct that was malicious or demonstrated reckless indifference to Plaintiff's federally protected rights.

VIII. PRAYER FOR RELIEF

WHEREFORE, Plaintiff respectfully requests that this Court enter judgment in her favor and award:

1. **Declaratory relief** that Defendants' conduct violated Title VII and the Florida Whistleblower Act;
2. **Back Pay, Front Pay, and Lost Benefits** in an amount to be proven at trial;
3. **Compensatory damages** for emotional distress and reputational injury;
4. **Punitive damages** in an amount sufficient to punish and deter Defendants;
5. **Attorney's fees and costs**; and

6. Such other relief as the Court deems just and proper.

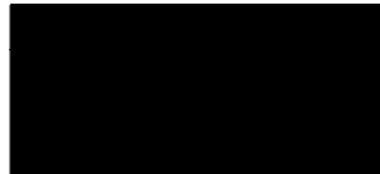
IX. JURY DEMAND

Plaintiff hereby **demands a trial by jury** on all issues so triable.

Respectfully submitted 13th of March, 2026,

A handwritten signature in cursive script, reading "Debra Nelson", written over a horizontal line.

Debra Nelson
Plaintiff, Pro Se



CERTIFICATE OF SERVICE

I hereby certify that a true and correct copy of the foregoing **Plaintiff's Seventh Amended Complaint** was served upon counsel for Defendants by email addressed as follows:

Lindsay D. Swiger

Zackary A Blanton

Jackson Lewis P.C.

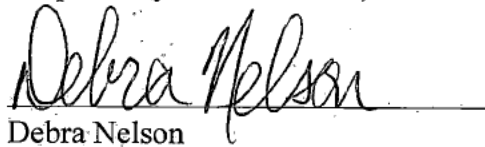
501 Riverside Avenue, Suite 902

Jacksonville, FL 32202

Email: Lindsay.Swiger@jacksonlewis.com

Zackary.Blanton@jacksonlewis.com

Respectfully submitted 13th, of March 2026,



Debra Nelson

Plaintiff, Pro Se



EXHIBIT A



Outlook

Step 3

From Debra Nelson <[REDACTED]>

Date Mon 8/18/2025 8:50 AM

To jLittlefield@iam75.org <jlittlefield@iam75.org>

Good morning. Is there a possibility of having the step 3 meeting on August 25, 2025?

Get [Outlook for iOS](#)

EXHIBIT B

Outlook

Re: Clarification Request – Step 3 Grievance Meeting

From: Debra Nelson <[REDACTED]>**Date:** Thu 10/16/2025 12:40 PM**To:** Jamie Littlefield <jlittlefield@iam75.org>**Cc:** James Carnley <hs11oo@hotmail.com>

I want to be clear that I am in the local area and available to meet, but I am not returning to the worksite while on medical leave because of the hostile conditions that remain unresolved.

So is this the representation that I paid for?

Get [Outlook for Android](#)

From: Debra Nelson <[REDACTED]>**Sent:** Thursday, October 16, 2025 11:37:24 AM**To:** Jamie Littlefield <jlittlefield@iam75.org>**Cc:** James Carnley <hs11oo@hotmail.com>**Subject:** Re: Clarification Request – Step 3 Grievance Meeting

Dear Mr. Littlefield,

Thank you for your reply. I am currently on an extended leave of absence that was necessitated by the hostile work environment I experienced at Amentum. I am in the local area and am available to meet in person at a neutral location or to participate by video or phone conference.

As I noted earlier, I already returned to work for more than thirty (30) days after my first leave, yet no Step 3 meeting was scheduled during that time. Requiring me to physically return to the same workplace before the grievance can proceed would place me back into the conditions that led to my leave of absence and would be inconsistent with both my health needs and my right to a safe work environment.

Please confirm whether District 75 will accommodate a meeting at a neutral site or via remote participation so that this matter can move forward.

Thank you,
Debra Nelson



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From: Jamie Littlefield <jlittlefield@iam75.org>**Sent:** Thursday, October 16, 2025 9:00:46 AM

EXHIBIT C

To: Debra Nelson <[REDACTED]>
Cc: James Carnley <hs11oo@hotmail.com>
Subject: Re: Clarification Request – Step 3 Grievance Meeting

Are you back to work? If so I will set it up as soon as possible.

Thank you,

Jamie R. Littlefield

ADBR

IAMAW District 75

jlittlefield@iam75.org

334-400-6386

On Thu, Oct 16, 2025 at 7:24 AM Debra Nelson <[REDACTED]> wrote:

Dear Mr. Littlefield,

I am following up regarding my Step 3 grievance meeting. I understand from prior communications that the Union believes I must return to work before this meeting can be scheduled.

As you are aware, I returned to work after my first medical leave and remained for more than thirty (30) days. During that period, no Step 3 meeting was ever scheduled. I am now on a second extended medical leave due to continued hostility and retaliatory conduct in the workplace.

I am willing to participate in the Step 3 meeting by video conference or at a neutral location to ensure my safety and to move the grievance process forward. Please confirm within seven (7) calendar days whether District 75 will accommodate this request or provide its position in writing.

I appreciate the assistance provided by our local steward, James Carnley, who has been supportive throughout this process. However, I have not received a response to my previous emails to your office dated August 6, 2025 and October 2, 2025.

Thank you for your time and attention.

Sincerely,
Debra Nelson

[REDACTED]

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2/9/26, 1:05 AM **EXHIBIT D**

RE: Leave of Absence Notification - Debra Nelson - Outlook



Outlook

RE: Leave of Absence Notification**From:** Hughes, Janice <Janice.Hughes@amentum.com>**Date:** Thu 9/18/2025 9:02 AM**To:** Debra Nelson <[REDACTED]>**Cc:** James Carnley <hs11oo@hotmail.com>

1 attachment (207 KB)

Claim Status/ ADA Follow-up;

Good day,
Please see attached email that was sent to you yesterday September 17, 2025, with additional information.

Thank you

**Ja'nice Hughes****Human Resource Generalist**

Aviation Solutions | Critical Missions

T 850-484-6250 M 850-816-9252

Janice.Hughes@amentum.com

7701 USS Enterprise Street, Milton, FL 32570

From: Debra Nelson <[REDACTED]>**Sent:** Wednesday, September 17, 2025 10:49 PM**To:** Hughes, Janice <Janice.Hughes@amentum.com>**Cc:** James Carnley <hs11oo@hotmail.com>**Subject:** [EXTERNAL] Re: Leave of Absence Notification

It's funny how you are demanding that I come back to work but have done NOTHING about the hostile work environment.

From: Hughes, Janice <Janice.Hughes@amentum.com>**Sent:** Thursday, September 11, 2025 3:56 PM**To:** [REDACTED] <[REDACTED]>**Subject:** Leave of Absence Notification

Good day

2/9/26, 1:05 AM

EXHIBIT D

RE: Leave of Absence Notification - Debra Nelson - Outlook

See attached and below Leave of Absence Status Notification



Date: August 13, 2025
 To: Debra Nelson
 From: Janice Hughes
 Subject: Formal Leave of Absence Status

Debra Nelson,

Amentum has received a formal notification from Hartford. In the notification, it has been stated that your claim(s) have been denied.

Hughes, Janice

From: JAHughes@amentum.com
 Sent: Wednesday, September 10, 2025 9:29 AM
 To: HR, Amentum, Debra Nelson
 Subject: DEBRA NELSON'S REQUEST FOR MEDICAL LEAVE OF ABSENCE - DENIED

This message is from an External Sender
 Do not click on links or open attachments from this email unless you are sure it is from a trusted source.

We've updated system information on Debra Nelson's School Term Disability claim. Please review the details below.

Employee Name: Debra Nelson
 Employee ID: 027906
 Claim Number: 05734245
 Final Day Absence: 08/18/2025
 Last Paid Day: 08/18/2025

Work Status: Yes
 Work State: Florida
 Preferred Contact #: 855/277-4142
 Disability Date: 06/06/2025
 Request Begin Date: 08/13/2025
 Total # of Days Requested: 0
 Max Benefit End Date: 02/05/2026

STD Plan Name: IND NBT 1 Class PRSO STD - DVAL & PROCES

Short-Term Disability
 DEBRA is eligible for the following reason: Work Related. This means their claim is not approved as of August 8, 2025.

We already had DEBRA's request for leave approved.

Leave of Absence Status
 Request for leave of absence denied. Please review the details below.

Final Payroll and Medical Leave are 08/18/25
 Status/Status Reason
 Denied - Medical Leave Requested

You also received a formal Request for Medical Leave of Absence Notification from HR, Janice Hughes, that was sent to you via email on August 13, 2025, and delivered to the address listed in Workday on August 18, 2025, notifying you of the process if approved or denied by Hartford. Due to your leave status claim, you are not authorized to be absent beyond Friday, September 12, 2025, and are required to return to work no later than Monday, September 19, 2025, at 2:00 pm CT. If you fail to return to work as directed, disciplinary action may be taken. You are required to notify Human Resources, Janice Hughes upon your return.

Regards,

Janice Hughes
 Janice Hughes
 Human Resource Generalist

Thank you

✕

Ja'nicé Hughes
 Human Resource Generalist
 Aviation Solutions | Critical Missions
 T 850-484-6250 M 850-816-9252

2/9/26, 1:05 AM **EXHIBIT D**

RE: Leave of Absence Notification - Debra Nelson - Outlook

Janice.Hughes@amentum.com

7701 USS Enterprise Street, Milton, FL 32570



EXHIBIT D



amentum

19 September 2025

Debra Nelson

Re: Follow-up on Leave and Claim Status

Dear Debra:

This memo serves as a follow-up to my September 11, 2025, email. As noted, you have been out on leave since August 8, 2025. On August 6, 2025, you filed a short-term disability and FMLA claim with The Hartford. We were notified on September 10, 2025, that your claim was denied.

You requested information on how to pursue a Workers' Compensation claim, and on September 11, 2025, I provided you with the contact information for the Injury Management Hotline. We were notified on September 12, 2025, that you filed the WC claim, and it is currently pending determination with our third-party vendor, Sedgwick.

Separately, while we do not know the nature of your condition, if you have a disability that requires an accommodation in order to perform the essential functions of your job, Amentum may be able to provide a reasonable accommodation under the Americans with Disabilities Act of 1990 ("ADA"). If you need a workplace accommodation to return to work in your role of NDI Technician, then you may want to consider filing an accommodation request with the Hartford. If you wish to consider this option, please contact The Hartford, and provide the below information:

- The policy number for The Hartford is 697755.
- Your Name, Address, and other identifying information
- Name of your department and last full day active at work
- The nature of the claim
- Your treating physician's name, address, phone, and fax numbers

Attendance is an essential function of your positions; it would be an undue hardship to allow you to remain on leave indefinitely. We are willing to consider providing you with a period of additional unpaid leave for medical reasons, or another appropriate accommodation if needed, but to make this determination, we will need for you to submit certain information from your physician as described in the attached ADA Workplace Accommodation. This additional information should be submitted to The Hartford if/when you file the accommodation claim.

Please note that you will be required to provide the attached Return to Work Certification to Human Resources and your supervisor within 3 business days of your scheduled return to work date.

Should you have any questions about your employment, please do not hesitate to contact me at 850-484-6250.

Sincerely,

Janice Hughes, HR Generalist

**Janice
Hughes**

Digitally signed by Janice Hughes
DN: cn=Janice Hughes,
o=AmentumT44, ou=Critical Mission
email=Janice.Hughes@amentum.com
Date: 2025.09.17 12:15:39 -0500



EXHIBIT D
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Enclosures:

- ADA Workplace Accommodation Questionnaire

EXHIBIT E



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October 29, 2025

Debra Nelson



Subject: Notice of Termination

In accordance with the Company's Human Resources Policy AM-HRS-PL-0309-LA, titled Professional Conduct (made available to you on the Company's Intranet), and IAW Exhibit B – Progressive Discipline Guide of the applicable CBA, Rule #5d unauthorized absence for three consecutive work shifts, this memorandum serves as notification you are being terminated effective today, October 29, 2025, for unauthorized absence for three consecutive work shifts.

As previously mentioned, you have been out on leave of absence since August 8, 2025. You were notified on September 10, 2025, that Hartford denied your Short-Term Disability and FMLA claim. Additionally, you were also notified that the WC claim you filed on September 12, 2025, was denied by our third-party vendor, Sedgwick, on October 14, 2025. Given the outcomes of these claims and the necessity of your attendance for your role to perform the essential functions of your position, as it would be an undue hardship to allow you to remain on leave indefinitely, you were notified on October 17, 2025, that you were required to return to work on October 20, 2025. You failed to report to work as instructed for your shift, and were sent a follow-up email on October 20, 2025, advising that if you failed to report to work by Wednesday, October 22, 2025, additional discipline up to and including termination would be taken.

Your final paycheck through October 29, 2025, and information on your benefit continuance will be forwarded to your home address. Please contact the Human Resource office at 850-484-6250 if you have questions.

Regards,

Clarence
Xander

Digitally signed by Clarence Xander
DN: cn=Clarence Xander, o=T34/T8,
ou=Amentum,
email=clarence.xander@amentum.com
Reason: I am approving this document

Clarence Xander
Program Manager

Enclosure: Benefits Continuation Letter
CC: Personnel File